

FREE GUIDE · TEXAS AI WEEKLY

THE WORKFLOW-FIRST PLAYBOOK

# Texas AI Quick-Start

Find the work where AI saves your team real hours, then roll it out so it actually sticks.

| 6 | 1 | 30 | 0 |
|---|---|---|---|
| simple steps | afternoon to plan | day pilot | buzzwords |



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WHY MOST AI ROLLOUTS STALL

# The tool wasn't the problem. The order was.

Someone buys AI licenses, tells the team "we have AI now, find ways to use it," and two months later the owner is paying for seats nobody opens. Flip the order and AI gets a real job, an owner, and a way to prove it worked.

### ✗ Tool first

1. Buy licenses
2. "Find ways to use it"
3. A few people experiment
4. Nobody measures anything
5. Seats go unused

vs

### ✓ Workflow first

1. Collect the friction
2. Pick one repeat workflow
3. Map how it runs today
4. Apply AI to specific steps
5. Measure for 30 days, then expand

**The rule:** Never ask "How can we use AI?" Ask "Which recurring piece of work would we most like to be faster, more consistent, or less dependent on one busy person?" Then decide whether AI fits that work.

## Your roadmap

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| 1 | **Collect the friction**<br>Ten minutes, six questions, the whole team. | 10 min |
| 2 | **Keep the work that repeats**<br>Score each item on four checks. | 20 min |
| 3 | **Map it in eight questions**<br>How the work really happens today. | 30 min |
| 4 | **Match steps to what AI does well**<br>Seven patterns, one clear sentence. | 30 min |
| 5 | **Measure, then pilot**<br>Baseline first, 30 days second. | 30 days |
| 6 | **Protect customer and patient data**<br>Decide what goes in before anything goes live. | before launch |

# 1 Collect the friction

10 minutes · everyone who does the work

Before you look at any technology, collect the pain. Write every answer down without judging it. Expect 10 to 20 items; plenty will have nothing to do with AI, and that's fine.

**What task do you dread every week?**

**What takes much longer than it should?**

**What gets redone because the first try was off?**

**What falls through the cracks when someone is out?**

**Where do you wait on one person before work moves?**

**What do customers complain about waiting for?**

# 2 Keep the work that repeats

20 minutes · score your top items

AI pays off on work that happens again and again. Circle 0 (no), 1 (somewhat) or 2 (clearly yes) for each check.

| Check | Question to ask | Item A | Item B | Item C |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Frequency** | Does it happen daily, weekly, or with every new client? | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 |
| **Consistency** | Are the inputs and outputs similar enough each time to standardize? | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 |
| **Ownership** | Is there a clear person or team who does it and would use a new process? | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 |
| **Clear pattern** | Do you know what starts it, what it touches, and who approves it? | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 | 0 1 2 |
| | **Total (out of 8)** | ◯ | ◯ | ◯ |

| 0–3 · skip for now | 4–5 · maybe | 6–8 · strong candidate |
|---|---|---|

A weekly client status report almost always beats a once-a-year strategy deck, even though the deck feels more important.

# 3 Map it in eight questions

30 minutes · with the person who does the work

For your top one or two candidates, write down how the work happens today, in plain words. No flowchart software needed.

**1 · Who**
does the work?

**2 · What**
moves through it (a proposal, a request, a report)?

**3 · Trigger**
What starts it?

**4 · Inputs**
What information does it need, and where does it live?

**5 · Steps**
What happens today, in order?

**6 · Decisions**
What gets approved or handed off?

**7 · Output**
What comes out at the end?

**8 · Why**
Why does it matter to the business or customer?

**EXAMPLE: THE PROPOSAL WORKFLOW**

A new lead fills out the intake form. The account manager builds a proposal from scratch, quality depends on who writes it, and leads wait days. Here is the same work, mapped and redesigned:

Intake form submitted › AI summarizes the intake notes › AI drafts scope from template + current pricing › Account manager reviews and edits › Owner approves anything over $10,000 › Proposal sent

☐ AI does the first pass ☐ a person decides

**What owners usually find:** much of the friction isn't technical at all. It's a missing template, a fuzzy handoff, or information scattered across five places. Fix those first and AI has something solid to work with.

## Your map

# 4 Match steps to what AI does well

30 minutes · now, and only now, bring in the tool

Look at each step in your map. Does it fit one of these seven patterns where tools like ChatGPT do well?

### Summarize

Long notes, transcripts or documents into a short brief.

### Draft and refine

A first version of a recurring document, then better tone and structure.

### Extract and structure

Key details from messy information into a table, checklist or template.

### Compare and recommend

Options, risks and tradeoffs laid out to support a decision.

### Prepare a brief

A meeting, account or project brief from background material.

### Review against a standard

Check work against a checklist, policy or style guide.

### Coach through a process

Step-by-step guidance when expert help is limited.

### Keep it human

Approvals, judgment calls and anything that carries a license stay with your people.

**Then write the one sentence your team can follow.**

"When a new lead completes the intake form, ChatGPT drafts the proposal from our template, current pricing and the client's notes. The account manager reviews and edits it. The owner approves anything over $10,000."

That sentence is the difference between "use AI more" and a workflow people actually adopt.

## Your sentence

# 5 Measure first, then run a 30-day pilot

baseline before you change anything

**Time**
Hours per proposal, report or request

**Speed**
Turnaround from trigger to finished output

**Quality**
Revisions, errors caught, consistency

**Capacity**
Volume the same team handles

**Experience**
Fewer late nights, faster answers

**Your baseline**

**0 — Day 0**
Record the baseline. Write the template, instructions and review step.

**1 — Weeks 1–2**
Run the new workflow on real work. Note every snag.

**3 — Week 3**
Fix the template and instructions. Keep the review step.

**30 — Day 30**
Compare to baseline. Numbers moved? Expand. Didn't? Adjust or move on.

# 6 Protect customer and patient data

settle this before anything goes live

**Usually fine to start with**
Public information, your own templates, fictional examples, published guidelines, general how-to content. A lot of real value lives here.

**Check your policy first**
Internal business data, client names, financials, contracts. Decide which tool may hold it and write the rule down for the team.

**Only in tools approved for it**
Protected health information goes only into a service your practice has a signed business associate agreement (BAA) for, and only on the product that agreement covers. Check the contract, don't assume.

**One more rule:** a person reviews before anything reaches a customer or patient. The tool drafts; your people decide.

This guide is general information, not legal, compliance or medical advice. Check your obligations with your own advisors.

BEFORE YOU START

# Red flags: when a workflow isn't ready

**Nobody owns it.**
No owner, no adoption.

**It happens once a year.**
The setup won't pay back.

**The process itself is broken.**
AI only makes a bad process faster. Fix the handoffs first.

**The data is off-limits.**
Solve the data question before you pilot.

**You can't measure it.**
If you can't tell it improved, you can't justify expanding it.

**Already bought the licenses?**
No need to start over. Pick one workflow and run steps 3–5 on it.

PIN THIS UP

## Your first week

- [ ] Run the friction inventory with your team.
- [ ] Score the list and pick one workflow.
- [ ] Map it in eight questions with the person who does the work.
- [ ] Write the one-sentence version of the new workflow.
- [ ] Record your baseline.
- [ ] Decide what data is allowed and who reviews the output.
- [ ] Start the 30-day pilot.

**Stuck on step 3 or 4?**
Hit reply on any Texas AI Weekly issue and tell me which workflow you picked. I read every reply.

Book a call

KEEP GOING

# Three ways to turn this into hours back

Pick the one that fits where you are.

## Read Texas AI Weekly

Every Thursday at 7 a.m. Central: what AI is doing in Texas, what it means for your business, and one thing to try that week. You're already on the list.

**Share it**

## Join a live workshop

Hands-on, two-hour sessions on Google Meet where you build the workflow with your own tasks. See current dates and prices.

**Workshops**

## Roll out ChatGPT with help

A workflow-first ChatGPT rollout for your team: find the work where it saves time, then roll it out so it sticks.

**Learn more**



WHO WROTE THIS

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Veteran-owned. Built in Texas for Texas businesses, clinics and teams.